

Asciidoctor Installation and Configuration Guide

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Table of Contents

1. Introduction	1
2. Prerequisites	2
3. Installation	3
3.1. Step 1: Install Ruby	3
3.2. Step 2: Install Asciidoctor	3
3.3. Step 3: Install PDF support	3
3.4. Step 4: Optional dependencies	3
3.5. Step 5: Install VS Code extension	3
4. Verify Installation	4
5. VS Code Configuration (Custom PDF Theme)	5
5.1. Step 1: Clone the theme repository	5
5.2. Step 2: Locate required files	5
5.3. Step 3: Configure VS Code settings	5
5.4. Step 4: Example configuration	5
5.5. Step 5: Verify configuration	6
6. Asciidoctor Upgrade	7
6.1. Update Asciidoctor	7
6.2. Clean old versions	7
7. Asciidoc editors	8
8. AsciiDoc Syntax Reference	9
9. Troubleshooting	10
9.1. Commands not recognized	10
9.2. PDF not using theme	10
9.3. Fonts not applied	10
9.4. VS Code export fails	10

Chapter 1. Introduction

This guide explains how to install, verify, and configure Asciidoctor with PDF generation and a custom theme in VS Code.

Chapter 2. Prerequisites

List of software to install

1. Ruby
2. Asciidoctor
3. asciidoctor-pdf
4. VS Code AsciiDoc extension



Watch this video for installation guidance: [Asciidoctor Markup Quick Start](#)



Ruby 3.x is recommended for compatibility with Asciidoctor and PDF tooling.

Chapter 3. Installation

3.1. Step 1: Install Ruby

Download and install Ruby:

[Ruby Downloads](#)



During installation, **uncheck** the MSYS install option.



After installation, restart your terminal to ensure Ruby is added to the system PATH.

3.2. Step 2: Install Asciidoctor

Open **Windows PowerShell as Administrator** and run:

```
gem install asciidoctor ①
```

① Installs the core Asciidoctor processor.

3.3. Step 3: Install PDF support

Install the PDF backend:

```
gem install asciidoctor-pdf ①
```

① Enables PDF generation.

Verify prerequisites if needed: [View prerequisites](#)

3.4. Step 4: Optional dependencies

```
gem install concurrent-ruby ①
```

```
gem install coderay ②
```

① Improves performance.

② Adds syntax highlighting (optional if using Rouge).

3.5. Step 5: Install VS Code extension

Install:

[AsciiDoc VS Code Extension](#)

Chapter 4. Verify Installation

```
ruby -v ①  
asciidoctor -v ②  
asciidoctor-pdf -v ③
```

① Confirms Ruby is installed.

② Confirms Asciidoctor is available.

③ Confirms PDF support is working.

If any command is not recognized, verify that Ruby is correctly added to the system PATH.

For additional diagnostics:

```
gem env ①
```

① Displays RubyGems environment details.

Chapter 5. VS Code Configuration (Custom PDF Theme)

This section configures VS Code to use a custom PDF theme.

5.1. Step 1: Clone the theme repository

```
git clone git@github.com:hotlanta/asciidoc_hcltech.git ①
```

① Contains theme and font files required for PDF styling.

 If SSH is not configured, use HTTPS:

```
git clone https://github.com/hotlanta/asciidoc_hcltech.git
```

5.2. Step 2: Locate required files

From the repository:

- Theme file: hcltech-theme.yml
- Fonts directory: fonts/

 Ensure all fonts referenced in the theme file exist in the fonts directory.

5.3. Step 3: Configure VS Code settings

Open VS Code → **Settings** → search for:

Asciidoc: Pdf Command Args

Add the following entries **individually**:

```
-B  
${workspaceFolder}  
-a  
pdf-theme=D:/path/to/asciidoc_hcltech/theme/hcltech-theme.yml  
-a  
pdf-fontsdir=D:/path/to/asciidoc_hcltech/fonts  
-r  
asciidoctor-lists
```

① Each -a must be a separate entry.

② Paths must be absolute.

③ Use forward slashes / on Windows.

 Do not combine arguments like:

```
-a pdf-theme=...
```

5.4. Step 4: Example configuration

```
-B  
${workspaceFolder}  
-a  
pdf-theme=D:/hotlanta_git/asciidoc_hcltech/theme/hcltech-theme.yml  
-a  
pdf-fontsdir=D:/hotlanta_git/asciidoc_hcltech/fonts  
-r  
asciidoctor-lists
```

5.5. Step 5: Verify configuration

Generate a PDF in VS Code:

- Open .adoc file
- Press Ctrl+Shift+P
- Select: AsciiDoc: Export document as PDF

If configured correctly: – Custom theme is applied – Fonts render correctly – No warnings appear in the output

Chapter 6. Asciidoctor Upgrade

6.1. Update Asciidoctor

```
gem update asciidoctor ①
```

① Updates to the latest version.

6.2. Clean old versions

```
gem cleanup asciidoctor ①
```

① Removes outdated versions.

Chapter 7. AsciiDoc editors

- [AsciiDoc VS Code Extension](#)
 - [AsciiDocFX Editor](#)
 - [Notepad++](#)
 - Any text editor
-

Chapter 8. AsciiDoc Syntax Reference

[Official Documentation](#)

Chapter 9. Troubleshooting

9.1. Commands not recognized

- Restart terminal
- Verify PATH configuration
- Reinstall Ruby if necessary

9.2. PDF not using theme

- Verify file paths
- Ensure arguments are separate
- Confirm theme file exists

9.3. Fonts not applied

- Check `pdf-fontsdir`
- Ensure fonts exist and are valid (TTF/OTF)

9.4. VS Code export fails

- Verify extension settings
- Restart VS Code
- Check output logs for errors